



National Social Science Association Board 2025 – 2026

Meet Our NSSA Board Members

Praphul Joshi – Sam Houston State University – Co-Director/President

Benita Bruster – Austin Peay State University – Co-Director

Anthony LaRose – University of Tampa

Munir Hassan – Johnson C. Smith University

Barba Patton – University of Houston – Victoria (Editor Technology Journal)

Beheruz Sethna – University of West Georgia

Imafedia Okhamafe – University of Nebraska – Omaha

Isela Almaguer – University of Texas Rio Grande Valley

Darrial Reynolds – South Texas College

Eileen Ariza – Florida Atlantic University (Co-Editor NSSA Journal)

James Benjamin – University of Arkansas – Fort Smith

Jeff Stomper – College of Lake County, IL

Krista Nelson – Southern Arkansas University

Brooke Garza – St. Rose of Lima Catholic School

Daniel Bailey – Austin Peay State University

Lucy Shirisia – Salt Lake Community College

Ron Childress – Marshall University

Brian Horn – Dallas Baptist University – Vice President Elect

Charmaine Lowe – Austin Peay State University – Secretary Elect

Teresa LeSage-Clements – University of Houston – Victoria

Daryl Ann Borel – Lamar University – President Elect

Sue Burum – Minnesota State University

Mihae Bae – Stephen F. Austin State University

Shelly Allen – Lamar University

Susanne Lapp – Florida Atlantic University (Co-Editor NSSA Journal)

Maria Teresa de Gordon – Neumann University

Barry Bruster – Austin Peay State University

Ryan Kelly – Arkansas State University

Vani Kotcherlakota – University of Nebraska at Kearney

Colleen McDonough – Neumann University



**NSSA Scholars Fall 2025 Conference Program
Hot Springs, Arkansas
October 19-21**

Education Examined

SUNDAY, October 19th, 2025

1:00 pm-5:00 pm	Registration	Atrium
5:00 pm-7:00 pm	Reception and Board Members Meeting	Atrium

MONDAY, October 20th, 2025

7:00 am-11:00 am	Registration	
7:00 am-9:00 am	Breakfast	Atrium
9:00 am-11:30 am	Sessions	Salons A & B
11:45 am-1:00 pm	Luncheon	Atrium
1:10 pm-5:00 pm	Sessions	Salons A & B

TUESDAY, October 21, 2025

7:00 am-9:00 am	Breakfast	Atrium
9:00 am-11:00 am	Virtual Presentations	
Zoom Links		
https://us06web.zoom.us/j/76698378686		Salon A
https://apsu.zoom.us/j/91440399362		Salon B



NSSA Paper Presentations Session Meeting Rooms on Monday, October 20

Session Chairs Monday, October 20, 2025

Salon A - Praphul Joshi
Salon B - Benita Bruster

9:00 AM-10:00AM
BREAKOUT
SESSION I
Salon A
Research Papers

Dialogues with the Machine: Introducing Philosophy Students to the Discipline through Socratic Exchanges with Artificial Intelligence

Trevor Hoag
Emporia State University

This presentation will focus on pedagogical experiments I conducted in my Introduction to Philosophy course and plan to continue in upcoming semesters. In the first “sessions,” learners prompted ChatGPT to imitate Socrates. Then they conversed with “him,” asking the pug-nosed gadfly questions based upon the textual materials from class, like the Republic and the Crito. After asking and answering questions alongside Socrates, learners reflected upon multiple questions: Is the artificial intelligence app. actually “thinking”?

The Evolving Culture of U.S. Higher Education in the Era of Online Learning

Keith Head
Capella University

The culture of higher education in the United States has been significantly transformed by the rapid growth of online learning, accelerated by the COVID-19 pandemic. This research examines how shifting from traditional in-person instruction to online modalities has impacted instructor-student engagement, conversational and community interaction, perceived educational quality, and student responsibility for self-directed learning at both undergraduate and graduate levels.

9:00 AM-10:00 AM
BREAKOUT SESSION
SESSION I
Salon B
Research Papers

Quantifying the Visibility of Twice Exceptional Education

Debbie Troxclair
Lamar University

Twice-exceptional (2e) students—those who are both gifted and have disabilities—remain largely invisible in educational research and practice due to disciplinary silos and inconsistent terminology. This study employs a quantitative content analysis research design to examine the diffusion of the term “twice-exceptional” across 100 peer-reviewed sources from 2010 to 2022 in gifted education, special education, and educational psychology. Findings reveal that while the term is well-established within gifted education, it is rarely referenced in special education or general education literature. This presentation explores the methodological approach, key findings, and actionable recommendations for expanding 2e discourse across educational domains. Attendees will gain insight into how research visibility—or lack thereof—shapes identification, support, and equity for twice-exceptional students.

**Did the Gun Really Pull the Trigger: A P-Curve Analysis of the
Original Weapons Effect Hypothesis**

James Benjamin
University of Arkansas-Fort Smith

Berkowitz and LePage (1967) found an interaction between provocation level and short-term exposure to weapons on aggressive behavior. In subsequent years, efforts to replicate the effect were attempted with varying degrees of success. This p-curve analysis examines whether this particular body of research holds the evidentiary value claimed by other social psychologists (e.g., Carlson et al., 1990). The findings of this p-curve analysis suggest that the evidentiary value of those early experiments may be less than it appears.

10:00 AM-10:25 AM Morning BREAK

10:30 AM-11:30 AM
BREAKOUT

**SESSION II Salon A
Research Papers**

Words Matter: Confusion in the Math and Science Classroom

**Barba Aldis Patton & Teresa LeSage Clements
TAMU-Victoria**

As one of my young students asked very politely one day, it made me realize that many words have one meaning, one for context, and one will have a totally different meaning in another setting. No wonder it is confusing. Students are often told to look for the biggest... but is it the size of a figure? Greatest amount? Or even the greatest value? Let's look at examples and why learning the correct academic language is absolutely imperative for young students to become masters in their academics.

Rocket Your Instruction with Math Concepts & Vocabulary

**Teresa LeSage Clements & Barba Patton
TAMU-Victoria**

National student measures of education progress have consistently shown decreasing test scores, especially in math, reading, and science. Additionally, there are significant differences in math and science achievement between males and females. Clearly, the instruction needs improvement. What is missing in the curriculum? Obviously, if students cannot read, then how can they perform well in math, science, or any other subject? Our research presents an argument for integrating math and science instruction to mesh math and science concepts and vocabulary across every grade level. This work will rocket your instruction with math concepts and vocabulary that improve your understanding of the academic language.

**10:30 AM-11:30 AM
BREAKOUT
SESSION II Salon B
Research Papers**

Capturing Efficiencies through Artificial Intelligence: AI for State and Local Governments

John Sutherlin
University of Louisiana Monroe

Artificial intelligence (AI) continues to cause concern, ranging from fear and alarm to jubilation, depending on the sector. For state and local governments, there is an opportunity to engage various AI platforms to assist with obligations faced by any public administrator. Whether the area is budget management, human resources, or procurement obligations, AI offers an opportunity for state and local governments to increase services, lower costs, and improve efficiency. This paper will review each of the administrative functions, determine if there are opportunities for improved efficiencies, and provide case studies for each. Then, focus will be given to other areas that may have an AI application while raising questions about the overall usage.

Salmon and Cattle Coexist in Oregon Estuaries as Collaborative Partners Reflect upon Eleanor Ostrom's Governance Scheme

Daniel Nuckols
Austin College

Various natural and human factors have adversely affected watersheds and estuaries, harming both ecosystems and economies. Unions of diverse partners address these negative impacts through conservation and restoration methods, often with negligible state influence over these partners' identification of ecosystem damages, reclamation strategies, or their governance schemes. Eleanor Ostrom identified global cases where successful non-state governance of common-pool resources exists, yet is generally dependent on core design principles. Seven participating alliances are currently addressing the ecological and farmland damage brought about by failing tide gates in the commons of the Coquille estuary, known as Winter Lake, in southern Oregon. The agency of individuals and groups depends upon their perceptions of their own successful governance of the commons, and, therefore, is crucial to the revitalization of ecosystems and economies.

	11:45 AM-1:00 PM	
LUNCHEON		Atrium

1:10 PM-2:10 PM

**BREAKOUT
SESSION III
Salon A
Research Papers**

Beyond the Silo: Preparing Educators to Support Gifted Learners through MTSS

**Debbie Troxclair
Lamar University**

This presentation introduces the MTSS+Gifted Module, a curriculum innovation designed to address two critical gaps in graduate educator preparation programs: the lack of training in Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS) and the persistent neglect of gifted learners' needs. While MTSS is widely implemented in K–12 settings to support all students through data-driven, tiered interventions, its application to gifted and twice-exceptional learners remains underdeveloped. Simultaneously, most educator preparation programs—both undergraduate and graduate—fail to provide adequate instruction on gifted education, leaving future educators ill-equipped to differentiate instruction for high-ability students.

**Utilizing a Community-Based Participatory Research (CBPR) Approach to
Implement a Resiliency Educational Intervention in a Multi-Disaster Community**

**Jill Killough & Jennifer Simmons
Lamar University**

Non-profit foodservice organization employees play a unique and vital role in providing essential services to vulnerable populations within a community. Disaster preparedness for foodservice operations can contribute to efficient food production and minimize food safety concerns in perilous times. Non-profit foodservice organization employees within the upper Gulf Coast Southeast Texas region have experienced multiple disasters for several years. This project aimed to develop an educational training method utilizing the community-based participatory method and a product tailored to meet the needs of non-profit foodservice organization employees to support their continued efforts in disaster preparedness. A mixed-methods design was utilized with a pre-post educational intervention. The results indicate that non-profit organization employees in a multi-disaster community value training in disaster management and planning.

**1:10 PM-2:10 PM
BREAKOUT**

SESSION III
Salon B
Research Papers

Raising Geography Student Performance in Upper-Level Classes

Timothy Bailey
Pittsburg State University

Challenges related to open-ended student learning and individual assessment from group activities are presented, concluding with issues we attempt to resolve.

What About Wolf Ridge

David Wallace
The Sequoyah Group

This paper presentation aims to provide findings from a case study analysis related to these areas of interest. The findings offer insights and implications for consideration by university faculty for planning and implementing educator preparation programs that focus on instructional practices related to project-based learning in schools. This paper presentation provides findings relevant to: (1) knowledge and understanding of implementing PBL, (2) coherence in the school's enabling environment to support and sustain an innovation like PBL, and (3) assessment and evaluation of student progress on desired learning outcomes.

2:15 PM-2:25 PM Cookie BREAK

2:30 PM-3:30 PM
BREAKOUT

SESSION III
Salon A
Research Papers

**Implementing CBPR Approaches for Reducing Health Disparities
In Rural and Underserved Communities**

Praphul Joshi
Sam Houston State University

This presentation will outline the principles of Community-Based Participatory Research (CBPR) in designing and implementing public health initiatives to address health disparities in rural and underserved areas. Examples from ongoing projects in Texas will be utilized to demonstrate the techniques used.

**Prevalence of Diabetes, Cardiovascular Disease, and Cancer Among U.S. Adults
who Use E-Cigarettes or Both E-Cigarettes and Conventional Cigarettes:
NHANES 2017–2020**

Kiran Sapkota
Sam Houston State University

Prevalence of Diabetes, Cardiovascular Disease, and Cancer Among U.S. Adults who Use E-Cigarettes or Both E-Cigarettes and Conventional Cigarettes: NHANES 2017–2020. Data were obtained from the 2017–March 2020 pre-pandemic National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey (NHANES). Adults aged ≥ 18 years were included. Current e-cigarette use was defined as past 5-day use, and current cigarette smoking was based on self-reported smoking status. Outcomes were self-reported diabetes, CVD (congestive heart failure, coronary heart disease, angina, myocardial infarction, or stroke), and cancer. Analyses incorporated sample weights and survey design, with logistic regression adjusting for age, sex, race/ethnicity, education, and poverty-income ratio.

Socio-behavioral Predictors of Non-Melanoma Skin Cancer in Texan Adults

Samantha Hansen Kiran Sapkota
Sam Houston State University

Introduction: Skin cancer represents a growing public health burden in the United States, particularly among fair-skinned populations. While ultraviolet (UV) exposure is the primary environmental risk factor, behavioral and occupational exposures may also contribute to non-melanoma skin cancer (NMSC) prevalence. This study explores potential relationships between demographic and behavioral variables (including age, smoker status, and history of military service) and self-reported NMSC in a representative sample of Texas adults. Methods: Cross-sectional data were drawn from the 2022 and 2023 Texas Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System (BRFSS), yielding a combined sample of 24,304 non-institutionalized adults. Core variables included

NMSC history, age, smoker status, and veteran status. Descriptive statistics, independent t-tests, and chi-square tests were conducted using SPSS to identify significant associations. Results: Approximately 9.6% of respondents reported a diagnosis of NMSC. Individuals with NMSC were significantly older than those without ($M = 71.2$ vs. 52.3 years, $p < .001$), with a large effect size (Cohen's $d = 1.046$). A significant association was also observed between smoking status and NMSC diagnosis ($\chi^2(3) = 146.72$, $p < .001$). However, no significant relationship was found between veteran status and NMSC history ($\chi^2(1) = 0.37$, $p = .544$). Conclusions: Age and smoking behavior were significantly associated with NMSC prevalence, while veteran status did not have significant predictive power. These findings reinforce the need for targeted prevention strategies focused on older adults and individuals with a history of tobacco use. Future multivariable models incorporating proxy measures of occupational sun exposure may inform equitable interventions.

NSSA RESEARCH SEMINARS PRESENTATION SESSION

**2:30 PM-3:30 PM
BREAKOUT
SESSION III
Salon B**

Integrating the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) into the Social Science Curriculum

**Catherine Hooey
Pittsburg State University**

It is common for sustainable development to be framed solely as an environment-focused concept founded in the earth sciences when, in fact, it is the integration of environmental, economic, and social equity goals in decision-making. The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development contains seventeen Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and was adopted by the United Nations in 2015 to serve as objectives to achieve "peace and prosperity for people and the planet" (<https://sdgs.un.org/goals>). The social science curriculum can play a vital role in teaching students about sustainable development and how social inequity issues, such as poverty, hunger, health/wellbeing, and gender inequality, as framed by the SDGs, can help us move toward a more sustainable world. This paper examines the role of the social science curriculum in furthering the understanding of sustainable development and its many challenges. It suggests approaches that might be used to achieve this.

The Impact of Civic Engagement on Trump Administration's Foreign Policy

Olusoji Akomolafe

Norfolk State University

American foreign policy has traditionally been shaped by elites, with minimal public participation. Under the Trump Administration, while the president pursued the “America First” agenda through executive action, civic actors—such as citizens, NGOs, courts, and advocacy groups—have influenced, challenged, and sometimes limited his policies. This paper analyzes how public engagement has acted as a check on unilateralism, keeping alternative foreign policy perspectives alive. Ultimately, it argues that foreign policy should be democratized and reflect public input, not just elite interests, through ongoing activism and advocacy.

From Mentee to Mentor: Navigating a Career in Academics

Whitney Gass
Southern Arkansas University

The journey of a career as a college professor is characterized by a multifaceted progression that blends intellectual pursuit, teaching expertise, and institutional service. This pathway typically begins with advanced graduate training, where individuals cultivate research competencies, subject matter expertise, and an initial professional identity under the guidance of mentors. Early career stages often involve postdoctoral or adjunct roles, which serve as transitions between graduate education and tenure-track appointments. During these formative years, mentorship is central, as novice academics learn scholarly practices and professional ethics from senior colleagues. Once in a faculty position, professors must balance scholarship, pedagogy, and service while gradually shifting from mentee to mentor. In this role, they guide graduate students, undergraduate researchers, and junior faculty, extending the cycle of academic growth. Securing tenure and promotion represents a milestone and recognition of contributions in research, teaching, mentorship, and service. Beyond tenure, professors refine their research agendas, expand teaching expertise, and often assume leadership roles within departments or professional organizations. Despite challenges such as heavy workloads and shifting institutional demands, the profession offers opportunities for lifelong learning, personal fulfillment, and societal impact through education and research. The progression from mentee to mentor highlights the cyclical and generative nature of academic life, emphasizing how guidance received in early stages evolves into the responsibility of fostering future scholars. This trajectory underscores the interplay between personal ambition, scholarly contribution, and the evolving landscape of higher education.

RESEARCH SEMINARS PRESENTATION SESSION
3:40 PM - 5:00 PM BREAKOUT SESSION
SESSION IV

Salon A

The Unseen Hand: The Social Worker's Role in End-of-Life Care

Cortney Sherman
Southern Arkansas University

The multifaceted process of end-of-life care requires a holistic approach, but often only medical professionals are examined despite the collaboration of an interdisciplinary team. While the roles of the physicians and nurses are essential to the dying process, the social, emotional, and familial resources are just as vital to the patient and their families. Social workers' unique skillsets help make the end-of-life journey's complexities less stressful and more peaceful. The focus here is to define and examine the critical role of the social worker within the interdisciplinary, palliative, and hospice care teams. This presentation argues that social workers' contributions are fundamental to achieving a peaceful and dignified end-of-life experience. Ultimately, the goal is to shed light on the "unseen hand" of the social worker while asserting that the social worker is an invaluable component of the end-of-life team and is essential in providing compassionate, high-quality end-of-life care.

The Impact of Fear of Failure on the Impostor Phenomenon

Krista Nelson
Southern Arkansas University

The concept of the Impostor Phenomenon (IP) as a theory has been trending for several years. The term, coined by Pauline Rose Clance and Suzanne Imes in the 1970s, identified an experience that can negatively impact an individual's self-esteem and feelings of self-worth. The impostor phenomenon is an experience in which an individual believes their personal successes result from luck or chance, or "being in the right place at the right time," and does not believe that their accomplishments result from their personal intelligence or capabilities. A person suffering from the impostor phenomenon believes that even though they are successful, their accomplishments result from a "fluke" or some other external circumstance. This presentation will expound on the characteristics of the impostor phenomenon and explain how fear of failure can intensify IP development. Treatment options to assist individuals displaying impostor phenomenon traits will be discussed.

Advancing AI Literacy from a Global Perspective

Benita Bruster, Barry Bruster & Joe Elarde
Austin Peay State University

This presentation explores global approaches to Artificial Intelligence (AI) literacy, focusing on China, India, the United States, and Russia. Each country has launched explicit plans to integrate AI education across K–12, higher education, workforce development, and public awareness. China and Russia pursue highly centralized strategies with strong state-led implementation, while India and the U.S. combine national direction with local or state-level execution. India stands out for embedding AI in the CBSE curriculum and public campaigns, while the U.S. emphasizes federal guidance, university fluency programs, and workforce readiness. This session proposes a U.S. course correction: setting measurable literacy goals, expanding teacher training, and launching nationwide public micro-learning opportunities. The presentation highlights comparative strengths, gaps, and pathways to establish U.S. leadership in AI literacy.

RESEARCH ROUNDTABLE SESSION
3:40 PM-4:40 PM BREAKOUT SESSION
SESSION IV
Salon B

Faux Math

Barba Aldis Patton & Teresa LeSage Clements
TAMU-Victoria

Students need to learn and be able to use mathematical language, or we will not see improvement in student math achievement. NAEP (2025) data indicate that most students are experiencing difficulties in math. This issue is worsening each year. Mathematical language should be incorporated into everyday instruction to equip students with the skills necessary to compete globally. Join our roundtable to explore how the current trend of some teachers using faux math and not mathematical language may hinder our students' math success.

Challenges and Successes of Teaching Demography to Undergraduates

Marisa Sanchez
California State University, Bakersfield

An undergraduate demography course can be perceived as challenging to students. In my eleven years of experience teaching demography at California State University, Bakersfield, student feedback highlighted two main challenges. Demography is a scientific discipline within the social sciences, often housed within sociology programs, which means many undergraduates only take one demography course in their undergraduate careers. Hence, students report frequently feeling overwhelmed by the newness and unfamiliarity of demographic theories, concepts, and measures. This paper attempts to address these two challenges through two instructional practices:

incorporating a flipped classroom model and in-depth lessons on writing about numbers/data into the course curriculum.

Integrating Emotional Intelligence and Cultural Intelligence in Professional Development for K-12 Teachers Working with Multilingual Learners: A Systematic Design Approach

Viktoria Korogodsky, Jillian R. Powers, Susanne Lapp, & Eileen Ariza
Florida Atlantic University

K-12 teachers face complex challenges that require more than traditional pedagogical training in multilingual and multicultural educational environments. This roundtable session presents an instructional module that integrates Emotional Intelligence (EQ) and Cultural Intelligence (CQ) as essential competencies for effective teaching of multilingual learners (MLs). Developed using the Dick and Carey systematic instructional design model, this professional development instructional module addresses a critical gap in teacher preparation through evidence-based design principles. Following this approach, the module development included a comprehensive needs analysis of K-12 teacher competencies, clear performance objectives linking EQ and CQ skills to classroom effectiveness, and criterion-referenced assessment tools. During the roundtable, the presenters share the module development process and the module itself, and they seek feedback from the academic community on the module's design, theoretical integration, and practical applications.

TUESDAY, October 21st, 2025

8:00 am-9:00 am	Registration	(in Front of Salons A & B)
7:00 am-9:00 am	Breakfast	Atrium
9:00 am-12:00 pm	Virtual Presentations	Salons A & B

ALL NSSA VIRTUAL SESSIONS ON Tuesday, OCTOBER 21, 2025
9:00 am-11:00 am

Virtual Research Presentations
9:00 AM-10:00 AM SESSION
Salon A

Virtual Session Chair, Praphul Joshi
Join Zoom Meeting

<https://us04web.zoom.us/j/76698378686?pwd=RJQ7Fw3EBjEVbzp76VvfdJPLOPVGsy.1>

Virtual Research Presentations 9:00 am-10:00 am

Salon A
Zoom Link:

<https://us04web.zoom.us/j/76698378686?pwd=RJO7Fw3EBjEVbzp76VvfdJPLOPVGsy.1>

Effective Meeting Strategies for Leaders of Hybrid Videoconferencing

Kim McGarraugh Jones
Central Washington University

Prior to the COVID pandemic, businesses and universities were already taking advantage of the benefits of offering video conferencing as an option for meetings. It can be convenient since members can join from anywhere and access the Internet. Telecommuting can save a company the costs of attendees' transportation and can be preferred because it allows for AI note summaries, transcription, and recordings. During the COVID pandemic, videoconferencing became mandatory for companies wishing to continue business. Businesses had to determine which platform would best meet their needs; many are choosing to continue offering videoconferencing as an option for employees. This presentation will discuss hybrid meeting leaders' responsibilities that can facilitate more effective meetings in which all participants do not experience meeting inequity and proximity bias. The presentation concludes with a checklist that hybrid meeting leaders can access when preparing for meetings.

Teacher Use of Metacognitive Practices in AP Programs Research

Ron Childress & Melissa Alexander-Blythe
Marshall University

Metacognition, or thinking about your thinking and learning, was formally recognized and labeled some 50 years ago. The concept has been extensively studied over the years, with results suggesting it is an effective approach to learning. The underlying premise is that if you develop an awareness of how you think and learn, you can use metacognitive strategies to facilitate more effective learning. Despite this evidence of a positive impact on learning, metacognitive strategies have not been consistently used in advanced high school curricula. This presentation will present findings from a class project investigating using metacognitive strategies in advanced courses in high and low SES high schools. Recommendations will be provided.

Virtual Research Presentations 9:00 am-10:00 am

Salon B
Virtual Session Chair
Benita Bruster

Zoom Meeting Link: <https://apsu.zoom.us/j/91440399362>

9:00 AM-10:00 AM SESSION I
Salon B

**Teaching the Teachers: Can AI Build Better Support Plans from Human Insight?
Research**

Shelly Allen, Frances Perez, Darryl Ann Borel
Lamar University

As schools face mounting pressure to retain and support educators, intervention planning for struggling teachers has become a critical focus for instructional leaders. This session explores how artificial intelligence (AI) can enhance the clarity, consistency, and impact of teacher support plans when guided by human insight. Drawing from a qualitative study of graduate students in a teacher leadership program, the presentation examines how candidates used AI tools to develop personalized coaching strategies, scaffold lesson materials, and generate differentiated instructional suggestions. Attendees will leave with practical strategies for integrating AI into teacher intervention workflows, sample tools for refining teacher support plans, and a deeper understanding of how technology can amplify, not replace, the human elements of teacher development.

**Older Adults' Perceptions of Physical Activity Programs in a Local Senior Center:
The Role of Fall History**

Mihae Bae & Hyunsook Kang
Stephen F Austin State University

The study examined older adults' perceptions of physical activity programs offered at a local senior center. An IRB-approved survey was distributed to program participants, with 57 responses analyzed (4 males; 53 females), ranging in age from 65 to 90 years.. Findings revealed a mixed pattern of results among participants with a history of falls or near-falls. ANOVA results indicated that fall history significantly predicted lower confidence in exercising independently, explaining approximately 25% of the variance in confidence scores ($F(1, 55) = 17.99, p < .001$). In contrast, correlation analyses indicated that participants with fall histories reported greater overall exercise confidence ($r = .50, p < .001$) and higher satisfaction with exercise programs ($r = .35, p = .007$), with fall history accounting for 12% of the variance in satisfaction ($F(1,55) = 7.73, p = .007$). These results suggest that while current programs are valued and appreciated by older adults with fall histories, program design may not fully address their maximum needs.

Research Virtual Roundtables & Seminars

10:00 AM-11:30 AM SESSION

Salon A

Virtual Session Chair, Praphul Joshi

Zoom Meeting Link:

<https://us04web.zoom.us/j/76698378686?pwd=RJQ7Fw3EBjEVbZp76VvfdJPLOPVGsy.1>

Supporting Teachers: A Collaborative Model of Multi-Tiered System of Supports (MTSS)

**Yan Yan & Thomas W Harvey
Lamar University**

The session will present key qualitative themes, discuss implications for practice, and provide recommendations for replicating this model of graduate-led professional development in diverse educational settings. By bridging theory, preparation, and practice, this research illustrates how collaborative, schoolwide approaches to MTSS can strengthen instructional coherence, expand educator capacity, and advance equity and success for all students.

Addressing and Managing Aberrant Behavior among Emergent Bilinguals In General Education Environments

**Charmaine Lowe & Ling Wang
Austin Peay State University**

Considering emergent bilinguals' adaptive processes, ways of facilitating English Language Learner (ELL) students' transitions and adjustments to mainstream United States (U.S.) schooling contexts are uncovered by understanding and effectively addressing subversive classroom behaviors. Identifying fundamental elements of classroom management while maintaining focus on the unique dynamics affected by linguistic diversity among student bodies remains crucial. The stages of cultural adaptation and related pedagogical strategies, emphasizing the creation of affirming classroom climates, should be considered when sculpting classroom climates. Facilitating the construction of a strong sense of community for those instructing or preparing pre-service teachers to instruct linguistically-diverse students, as well as to equip those same professionals and pre-service professionals to address forms of oppositional behavior that most commonly arise among English Language Learners, remains imperative in U.S. classrooms.

The Role of Culture in Sustainable Development:

Global Perspectives from India

**Evelyne Delgado-Norris
Chicago State University**

It has long been recognized and now highlighted by the United Nations in their efforts for sustainable development worldwide that culture is an essential component in development strategies and a driving force for progress and creative solutions. The presentation will draw on aspects explored during a 2025 CAORC faculty development fellowship in India to highlight three facets of culture in sustainable development: Culture and Education as Foundations of Sustainability, Culture as Catalyst for Creativity, and Women, Culture, and Sustainable Development.

*CAORC is "Council of American Overseas Research Centers"

Thank you for all your hard work & for being an NSSA Scholar!

**Information on our Publishing Opportunities & SAVE THE
DATE for the National Social Science Las Vegas Conference -
March 22 - 24, 2026, Planet Hollywood**



NATIONAL SOCIAL SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY SPRING 2026
CONFERENCE
Planet Hollywood, Las Vegas

Our upcoming Las Vegas conference at the Planet Hollywood is from **March 22 through 24, 2026**. The conference has negotiated rooms at Planet Hollywood for a reduced price of **\$69.00**. Rooms at this reduced will go quickly!

- Enjoy an evening reception , poster presentations, and a networking session on Sunday (March 22nd)
- Board of directors meeting on March 22
- Complementary breakfast on Monday and Tuesday (March 23 and 24)
- Awards Luncheon and keynote speaker on Monday (March 23)
- Seminar sessions, research presentations, and round table sessions on Monday and Tuesday (March 23 and 24)
- Reduced early registration rates for all attendees registering before Feb 18th.

STUDENT PAPER COMPETITION

NSSA is offering a “Student Paper Competition” at the conference. Graduate and undergraduate students are encouraged to submit a paper and attend the conference. The scoring rubric and paper expectations are located at <https://nssascholars.org/student-paper-competition/>. Papers will be eligible for peer-review process to be published in the National Social Science Journal.

Submit your student papers to brusterb@apsu.edu. **Student papers are due by 2/18/2026. We have special conference registration rates: Professionals - \$350, graduate students - \$250.00, and undergraduate students - \$200.00.**

We have three-session formats, research presentations, traditional seminars, and roundtable session offerings; there is something for everyone. The **proposal deadline is February 18, 2026**. Use the link below to our new NSSA webpage to send your conference presentation proposal, register for the conference, and get your Planet Hollywood hotel room.

<https://nssascholars.org/>

We are eager to welcome you to the conference and look forward to seeing you in Las Vegas on March 22 - 24, 2026!

Proceedings & Journal Article Submission

Submit your manuscript directly to the editors. All technology papers go to pattonb@uhv.edu, and all other papers and proceedings go to brusterb@apsu.edu

Hot Springs Fall Conference Papers and Proceedings Submission Deadline is November 24, 2025.

NSSA Journal and NSSA Technology Journal Guidelines and Submission Information

Author's Template for Articles

Replace the words Author's Template for Articles with your manuscript's title.

Author(s) Name(s)	Author(s) Name(s)	Author(s) Name(s)
<i>Author Affiliation(s)</i>	<i>Author Affiliation(s)</i>	<i>Author Affiliation(s)</i>
<i>Author Affiliation(s)</i>		

Abstract

*The abstract is to be in fully justified italicized text, as it is here, below the author's information. Use the word "Abstract" as the title, in 12-point Ariel or Times New Roman, boldface type, centered relative to the column, initially capitalized. The abstract should be in 12-point, single-spaced type and up to 250 words. Leave two blank lines after the abstract to add the keywords, then leave two blank lines to begin the main text. *The submission cannot have been previously published nor submitted to another journal for consideration simultaneously.*

Key Words: (3-5 words)

Introduction: Skip two lines and begin your paper after the keywords. These guidelines include complete descriptions of the fonts, spacing, and related information for producing your manuscripts. Please follow them.

Formatting your Paper

All printed material, including text, illustrations, and charts, must be kept within a print area with 1" margins. Do not write or print anything outside the print area. The text must be fully justified. Images must be centered or within the text. Papers must be submitted in WORD only. No PDF files will be accepted. Make sure to disable ALL document security.

Type style, Font, and Length

Use Arial or Times New Roman in 12pt. All text should be 1.5 or double-spaced. Paragraphs should be indented. **Do not put in headers, footers, or running heads.** Papers submitted should not exceed **25 pages nor be fewer than 12 pages.**